

Alim's Study Assistant

User guide for Swiss Gymnasium exam preparation

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This guide describes what the app does today and clearly marks features that are planned but not yet available.

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1. Welcome

Alim's Study Assistant is a study companion for a Swiss Gymnasium student. It brings your subjects, grades, study material, timetable, exam planning and an AI study chat together in one calm, uncluttered place, so preparing for an exam does not mean juggling five different apps.

The app is organised around seven main areas: Home, School, Planner, Assistant, Statistics, Help and Feedback. Everything you save belongs to you alone and is stored under your own account.

How to read this guide

- Sections marked **available now** describe behaviour you can use today.
- Sections marked **planned** describe work that is prepared in the interface but still waiting on the study engine that runs on the local machine.
- Screen names are written exactly as they appear in the navigation bar.

Nothing in this guide requires technical knowledge. If a step does not match what you see, check the troubleshooting chapter near the end.

2. Signing in and your account

The first screen you see is the welcome screen. From there you can create an account or sign in. You may sign in with an email address and password, or with GitHub, LinkedIn or Spotify if those sign-in methods have been enabled for your installation.

Creating an account

- Choose a username. Usernames are stored in lower case and must be unique.
- If the name is already in use, the app tells you straight away and asks you to pick another one.
- Enter your email address and a password you do not use anywhere else.
- Confirm your email address if your installation asks for confirmation.

Signing in and out

Once you are signed in, the app takes you to Home. To sign out, open the round profile button at the top right of the header and choose Sign out. Signing out clears your session on this device only; your saved data stays safe in your account.

If you forget your password, use the password reset link on the sign-in screen. You will receive an email with a link that lets you set a new password.

3. Finding your way around

The header is present on every screen. On a wide screen it shows the app name on the left, the main navigation in the middle, and your tools on the right. On a phone the navigation collapses into a menu button.

The header, from left to right

- Menu button (small screens only) opens the full navigation list.
- App name returns you to Home from anywhere.
- Navigation links: Home, School, Planner, Assistant, Statistics, Help, Feedback.
- The clock shows the current local time in 24-hour format.
- The light and dark switch changes the appearance of the whole app.
- The bell opens your notifications.
- The flag button opens the language menu.
- The round profile button opens your profile and settings, and holds Sign out.

Breadcrumbs and back links

Most inner screens show a short trail at the top, for example Home / School / Biology. Use it to move back one level without losing your place. A dedicated back link sits next to the trail on screens you reached from a card or list.

The dark and light appearance setting and your language choice are remembered between visits.

4. Choosing your language

The app is fully available in five languages: English, German, Russian, Spanish and French. Choosing a language changes every label, button, heading, message and confirmation across the whole app immediately, without reloading the page.

How to switch

- Open the flag button in the header, between the bell and your profile picture.
- The trigger shows the flag of the language you are using now.
- Each menu entry shows a flag and the language name written in that language.
- Pick a language. The screen updates at once.

What is remembered

Your choice is saved with your account, so it follows you to any device where you sign in. A small copy is also kept in this browser, which is why the welcome screen already appears in your last language before you sign in.

Dates, times and numbers follow the chosen language where practical, so a date looks natural in German, Russian, Spanish or French. Times stay in 24-hour format, which is the Swiss convention.

Your own text is never translated. Subject names you typed, file names, notes and chat messages always stay exactly as you wrote them. If a translation is ever missing, the app quietly shows the English wording instead of breaking the screen.

5. Home

Home is your daily starting point. It gathers what matters today: your next exams, the subjects that need attention, recent grades and quick links into the rest of the app.

What you find there

- Upcoming assessments with the days remaining.
- A short overview of your current average.
- Subjects that are close to a critical grade, so they are easy to spot.
- Shortcuts to the Planner, to a study chat and to your subjects.

Cards on Home are links. Selecting a subject card opens that subject's workspace; selecting an exam opens it in the Planner. Nothing on Home changes your data, so you can explore it freely.

Academic year

The app works one academic year at a time. The year selector lets you look at an earlier year without changing anything. Grades from previous years remain available for your statistics.

6. School and your subjects

The School screen lists every subject you follow, each with its current average and its recent assessments. Subjects can be sorted so that the ones needing work appear first, and a subject sitting below the pass mark is styled clearly so you cannot miss it.

Combined subject

Biology and Chemistry are followed together as a combined specialist subject. They appear as one card, and the combination counts once towards your yearly average rather than twice. Inside the card you can still see each part separately.

A subject workspace

- The subject average and how it was calculated.
- All assessments for the year, with dates and weights.

- Study material you have uploaded for that subject.
- Links to the subject's own study chat.
- Useful school links you have saved.

You can add, edit and remove assessments at any time. Every change updates the average and the statistics immediately.

7. Study material

Each subject has a material area where you can keep the documents you actually study from: your notes, the syllabus, past papers, grading criteria and reference sheets.

Uploading

- Open a subject and go to its material area.
- Choose the files you want to add.
- Wait for the upload to finish; the list refreshes on its own.
- Remove a file at any time if it is out of date.

Your material is private. Files are stored in a private area reserved for your account, and nobody else can list or open them.

Material you upload yourself is kept until you delete it. It is **not** affected by the thirty-minute rule described later in this guide, which applies only to media the assistant produces or fetches.

8. Grades and how they are calculated

The app uses the Swiss grading scale from 1.0 to 6.0, where 4.0 is the pass mark. A grade is calculated from the points you achieved and the maximum points available.

The formula

Grade = $1.0 + 5.0 \times (\text{points achieved} \div \text{maximum points})$. A perfect result gives 6.0 and an empty result gives 1.0. Results are rounded the way your school rounds them, and the app always shows you the underlying points as well.

Averages

- A subject average is the weighted average of its assessments.
- The yearly average combines subject averages, counting the combined specialist subject once.
- Assessments you mark as not counting are shown but left out of the average.
- Grades below the pass mark are highlighted in every list.

If you receive a printed report, you can enter its grades through the transcript import dialog instead of adding each assessment one at a time.

9. Planner and your timetable

The Planner holds your week: lessons, exams, sport, music, appointments and study blocks. The timetable is shown in 24-hour format and you can create, edit, move and delete entries freely.

Creating an entry

- Choose the day and the start and end time.
- Give the entry a title and, if relevant, link it to a subject.
- Mark it as repeating if it happens every week.
- Save. Overlapping entries are flagged so you can decide what to keep.

Google Calendar

You can connect Google Calendar so your existing appointments appear beside your school week. This connection is strictly read-only: the app shows your appointments and refreshes them regularly, but it never creates, changes or deletes anything in your Google Calendar.

- Appointments coming from Google carry a badge and cannot be edited here.
- Edit them in Google Calendar; the change appears after the next refresh.
- You can disconnect at any time, which simply hides them again.
- The app only reports itself as connected once it truly holds a usable authorisation.

Connecting Google Calendar requires the sign-in provider and permissions to have been set up for your installation. Until then the card explains that the connection is unavailable.

10. The Assistant and study chat

There are two conversation areas. The study chat inside a subject is focused on that subject and its material. The Assistant is a general area for anything else: planning, study technique, quick explanations and organising your week.

Working with threads

- Each conversation is a thread with its own title and history.
- Threads are stored under your account and are available on any device.
- You can rename or delete a thread at any time.
- Deleting a thread removes its messages permanently.

Attachments

In the Assistant you can attach a small file to a message, for example a photo of an exercise or a short document. Attachments stay in your private storage area and are subject to a size limit shown next to the attachment button.

Answers are produced by the study engine running on the local machine. If that engine is not running, the app tells you plainly instead of inventing an answer.

11. Which language the assistant answers in

The intended rule is simple. Your app language is the default answer language, but if you write a message in another one of the five supported languages, the answer should come back in that language.

Examples

- App language German, message written in German, answer in German.
- App language German, message written clearly in Russian, answer in Russian.
- App language French, message too short or mixed to judge, answer in French.
- Message in a language outside the five, answer falls back to your app language.

What works today

The app already recognises the language of your message and keeps that information alongside the message. Cyrillic text is recognised with certainty; for the Latin-script languages the app uses a cautious estimate and prefers your app language whenever it is not confident.

Planned: the study engine does not yet receive or honour this language information. Until that work is done, answers may not follow the rule above. Your own message is never rewritten or translated.

12. Listening to answers

Answers can be read aloud. A Listen control appears on completed answers in both the study chat and the Assistant; while speech is running, the same control becomes Stop.

How it works

- Your browser performs the reading; nothing is uploaded and no audio file is created.
- The voice follows the language of the answer when a matching voice exists, otherwise your app language.
- Speech stops when you leave the conversation or switch to another thread.

- If your device has no speech voice available, the app says so rather than pretending to play.

Audio settings

Settings has two controls. The first switches read-aloud on or off entirely; when it is off, the Listen control disappears. The second enables automatic playback, which reads only a newly finished answer and never replays your older history when a page opens.

Spoken audio is never saved. Each reading is generated on your device for that moment only.

13. Statistics

The Statistics screen turns your grades into a picture: how each subject has developed, where your average is going, and which subjects deserve the next study block.

What you can see

- Average per subject and across the year.
- Development over time, so an upward or downward trend is visible.
- Distribution of your results and the number of assessments behind each figure.
- Subjects below the pass mark, listed separately.

Statistics are calculated from the grades you entered, so they update the moment you record a new result. Numbers and dates use your chosen language.

14. Storage, and the thirty-minute media rule

Settings shows how much storage your account uses and lets you clean up what you no longer need. There are two different kinds of file in the app, and they are treated differently.

Your own study material

Documents, notes and images you upload as study material are kept for as long as you want them. They are deleted only when you delete them, or when you run a cleanup yourself.

Media the assistant produces or fetches

Images, audio and video that come out of an assistant answer are treated as temporary. Thirty minutes after they are created they become eligible for deletion. Before the original is removed, a written description of it is kept, together with the address it came from if it was fetched rather than generated. Later on, the assistant works from that description instead of the original file.

- The original media is temporary and clearly marked as such.
- The written description is what remains available afterwards.
- Where the media was fetched, its source address is kept with the description.
- This rule never applies to the study material you uploaded yourself.

Planned: the app already carries the interface and the record-keeping for this policy, but writing the descriptions and removing the originals after thirty minutes is work for the study engine on the local machine and is not active yet.

15. Profile and settings

Your profile holds who you are: your username, full name, the name you prefer to be called, your nationality, contact details and your profile picture. Your picture is stored privately and is only shown to you.

Settings at a glance

- Account: change your email address or password.
- Study engine: choose which local model size to use.
- Notifications: exam reminders and the daily study summary.
- Sound effects for small interface confirmations.
- Audio responses: read aloud, and automatic playback.
- Storage: see what you use and clean up old files.

Every setting is saved to your account as soon as you change it, so the same preferences greet you on another device. The language selector deliberately lives in the header rather than in Settings, because you may want it before you reach any screen.

School links

You can save the web addresses you use often, such as the school portal or a subject page, and open them from your profile.

16. Feedback and privacy

The Feedback screen sends a note straight to the project inbox. Choose a category, write what happened or what you would like, and send. Your message is stored with your account so a reply can be traced back to you.

What the app records about usage

- Which screens were opened and which actions succeeded or failed.
- For a failure, only a short classification, never the underlying message.
- Never your password, your chat messages, your feedback text or your appointment details.
- Never the contents of your files or the values you typed into a form.

This record exists to spot broken screens, not to observe you. Your study material, grades, conversations and profile are visible only to your own account, enforced by the database itself rather than only by the interface.

17. If something does not work

The screen is empty or stuck

Reload the page. If the screen stays empty, sign out and sign in again. A stale session is the most common cause.

The language did not change everywhere

Switching language is instant. Text that is your own, such as a subject name you typed or a file name, is never translated, so it will keep the wording you gave it.

The assistant does not answer

The study engine runs on the local machine. If it is not running, answers cannot be produced. The app tells you when the connection fails rather than inventing a reply.

Nothing is read aloud

Check that read-aloud is switched on in Settings, and that your device offers a speech voice. Some browsers offer no voice at all, in which case the app says so and the control stays inactive.

Google Calendar shows nothing

The connection must be set up for your installation and you must grant permission to read your calendar. Appointments from Google cannot be edited in this app by design.

A grade looks wrong

Open the assessment and check the points and the maximum points. Also check whether the assessment is marked as counting towards the average.

18. Quick reference

Where things live

- Language: flag button in the header.
- Appearance: sun and moon switch in the header.
- Notifications: bell in the header.
- Sign out: round profile button in the header.
- Grades and assessments: School, then a subject.
- Exams, lessons and appointments: Planner.
- Conversations: Assistant, or the study chat inside a subject.
- Averages and trends: Statistics.
- Read aloud, storage, account: Settings.
- These guides: Help.

Numbers worth remembering

- Grade scale 1.0 to 6.0, pass mark 4.0.
- $\text{Grade} = 1.0 + 5.0 \times (\text{points} \div \text{maximum points})$.
- Five interface languages: English, German, Russian, Spanish, French.
- Assistant output media: temporary after thirty minutes, description kept.
- Google Calendar: read-only, always.

Questions or ideas belong in Feedback. Everything marked as planned in this guide is prepared in the interface and waiting on the study engine that runs on the local machine.